

Remote Access and VPN Policy

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1. Purpose and scope

This policy governs how Zuqah Technologies employees, contractors and approved third parties connect to internal systems from outside a Zuqah Technologies office. It applies to every device that establishes a remote session, including company laptops, company mobile devices and approved personal devices enrolled in mobile device management.

It does not cover physical access to offices, which is covered by the Facilities Access Standard, or access to customer environments, which is governed by the individual customer's own agreement.

2. Approved connection methods

2.1 Zuqah Technologies VPN

The Zuqah Technologies VPN client is the only approved method for reaching internal applications, file shares and administrative interfaces from outside the office. It is pre-installed on all company laptops issued after 1 March 2025.

Connecting requires:

- A valid Zuqah Technologies account in good standing
- Multi-factor authentication, completed at each connection
- A device that passes the posture check described in section 4

2.2 Browser-based applications

A small number of applications — Zuqah Technologies Mail, Zuqah Technologies Teams, the HR portal and the expense system — are published directly to the internet and do not require the VPN. These are protected by conditional access and multi-factor authentication. Employees do not need to connect to the VPN to reach them.

2.3 Methods that are not approved

Third-party remote desktop tools, personal VPN services, consumer file-sync applications and unmanaged SSH tunnels must not be used to reach Zuqah Technologies systems. Where a business need cannot be met by the approved methods, raise a request with Infrastructure Services rather than working around the restriction.

3. Setting up VPN on a new device

New starters receive a laptop with the VPN client already installed and configured. First-time connection takes about five minutes.

- 1. Connect the laptop to any working internet connection — home broadband, a

phone hotspot or a guest network are all acceptable.

- 2. Open Zuqah Technologies VPN from the Start menu.
- 3. Enter your Zuqah Technologies email address. The client fills in the connection profile automatically; there is no server address to type.

- 4. Complete the multi-factor prompt on your registered device.
- 5. Wait for the status indicator to turn green and read Connected.

The first connection also runs a posture check and may install pending security updates before allowing access. This can add several minutes on the first attempt and does not recur.

If the client is missing from a laptop that should have it, raise a ticket with IT Support rather than downloading an installer from elsewhere.

4. Device posture requirements

A device is permitted to connect only when all of the following are true. The check runs at every connection attempt.

Requirement	Threshold
Operating system updates	No missing update older than 14 days
Disk encryption	Enabled on all fixed drives
Endpoint protection	Installed, running, definitions under 7 days old
Screen lock	Enabled, 15 minutes or less
Device enrolment	Enrolled in Zuqah Technologies device management

A device failing any of these is refused and shown which requirement failed. Most failures are resolved by allowing pending updates to install and retrying.

5. Session limits

- A session disconnects automatically after 12 hours and must be re-established.
- A session idle for 30 minutes is disconnected. Idle means no traffic at all, not merely no keyboard activity.
- An account may hold two concurrent VPN sessions. A third connection attempt disconnects the oldest session.

These limits are not configurable per user.

6. Common problems and how to resolve them

6.1 *The connection drops repeatedly*

Frequent disconnection is usually caused by an unstable local network rather than by the VPN. Before raising a ticket:

- 1. Confirm other devices on the same network are stable.
- 2. Move closer to the wireless access point, or connect by cable.
- 3. If using a phone hotspot, note that carrier-grade network address translation

frequently interrupts VPN sessions. This is expected and cannot be corrected from the Zuqah Technologies side.

- 4. Restart the laptop. This clears a stale network adapter state that accounts for a meaningful share of reported disconnections.

- 5. Reconnect and note whether the drop happens at a consistent interval. A consistent interval points to a session limit in section 5; an irregular one points to the local network.

If the problem persists after these steps, raise a ticket and include how long the connection lasts before dropping, whether it is wired or wireless, and any error number shown.

6.2 *Authentication fails*

Confirm the multi-factor prompt is reaching your registered device. If your phone has been replaced recently, the registration must be moved before VPN access will work — see the Password and Multi-Factor Authentication Standard.

6.3 *The connection succeeds but internal sites do not load*

This usually indicates a name resolution problem. Disconnect, restart the laptop and reconnect. If the problem continues, raise a ticket noting which specific internal addresses fail and whether they fail by name, by address, or both.

7. Contractors and third parties

Non-employees may be granted VPN access for a fixed period, not exceeding the duration of their engagement and never longer than six months without renewal. Access requires a sponsor who is a Zuqah Technologies employee at manager level or above. The sponsor is accountable for confirming the access is still required at renewal and for notifying Infrastructure Services when the engagement ends.

8. Monitoring and enforcement

Connection metadata — account, time, source country, device identifier and duration — is retained for 90 days. Session content is not inspected.

Connections from countries outside the approved list are blocked by default. Employees travelling outside the approved list should request temporary access at least five business days before departure; see the

Travel and Reimbursement Policy for the broader travel notification process.

Repeated deliberate circumvention of this policy is treated as a disciplinary matter under the Code of Conduct.

9. Exceptions

Exceptions require written approval from the Head of Infrastructure Services and are granted for a maximum of 90 days. Requests should state the business need, the systems involved and the compensating controls proposed.

this document describes no real organisation's policy.*

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.